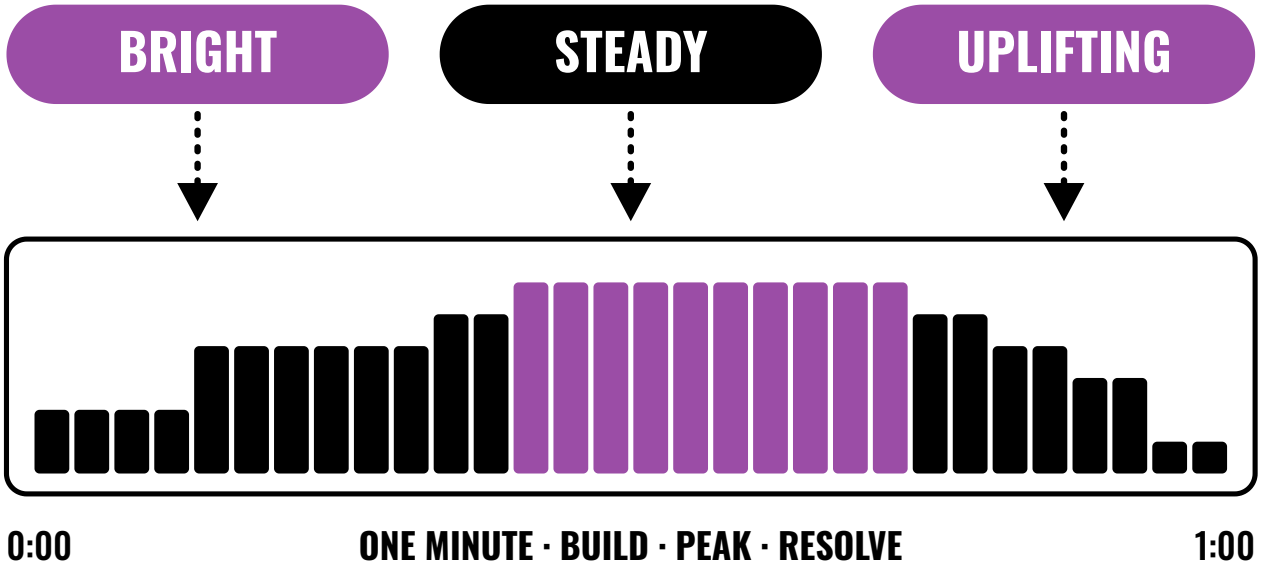
HUDSON BEAT



MUSIC WITH A JOB TO DO
ROYALTY FREE

DMP2 · functional composition · intro slides

GRADES 9–12 · 7 CLASS PERIODS · 25 PAGES + 19-SLIDE DECK

ROYALTY FREE

How to use this resource

START HERE

Teacher

WHAT THIS IS ·

A 7-class-period structured project for high school music technology. Each student composes a one-minute piece of royalty-free music in Logic, as if for a school video, guided by three descriptive words they choose from a list. They plan it as a creative brief, give it a build, a peak and a resolve, mix it, write a paragraph on how it reflects their words, and present it with Padlet questions for feedback. It is the project from my Digital Music Production 2 course (type: structured; focus: functional composition), and the projects in that course can be taught in any order.

QUICK START ·

1. Read the pacing guide (page 5) and my teacher notes (pages 6–7).
2. Set up the Presentation Padlet and decide how you will treat Apple Loops (page 4).
3. Print the student pages (pages 13–24), one set per student.
4. Open the intro deck and read the speaker notes for Class 1.

THE INTRO DECK ·

Every slide has a class: Class 1 (slides 1–7), Class 2 (slides 8–9), Class 3 (slides 10–12), Class 4 (slide 13), Class 5 (slides 14–15), Class 6 (slides 16–17) and Class 7 (slides 18–19). Every slide has speaker notes.

Fonts: the deck uses Oswald and Source Sans 3 (free on Google Fonts, built into Google Slides). If PowerPoint or Keynote shows a different font, install the two fonts or present the PDF copy, which shows the intended look.

WHAT'S INSIDE ·

PART	PAGES	USE
Teacher pages	pages 2–12	How to use, overview, setup, pacing, teacher notes, what changed, Logic quick reference, Easier and Harder variations, worked example (2 pages)
Student pages	pages 13–24	Word list, Creative brief, Listening log, Arrangement plan, Layers and mix sheet, project sheet (3 pages), rubric, vocabulary, feedback planner, reflection planner
Intro deck (separate file)	deck	19 slides, .pptx + PDF, speaker notes on every slide

NO AUDIO INCLUDED

No audio, video, songs, artists or albums are named or included. Students make every sound in their tracks themselves, from the instruments, kits and Apple Loops in Logic.

MAKE IT FIT YOUR CLASS ·

- **Easier or harder:** my variations on page 6: 2 words and a structural template, or scoring to a real video clip (both laid out on page 10).
- **Feedback board:** my sheets use Padlet for the three questions; any class board works.
- **Word choice:** students choose their three words from the list; you could also assign them with a wheel, as a kit suggestion.
- **Grading:** my rubric, /25, the average of the student's and your score (page 21).

IN ONE SENTENCE

Students learn that music can have a job to do, and that three well-chosen words are a creative brief.

Logic Pro and Apple Loops are products of Apple Inc. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

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ROYALTY FREE

Project overview

OVERVIEW

DMP2 · Structured

FROM MY DMP2 PROJECT MENU

Royalty Free · Structured · Functional Composition

Create a 1-minute piece for media use, guided by 3 descriptive words. Compose for a purpose, not just yourself.

WHAT STUDENTS MAKE ·

One original piece of royalty-free music, about one minute long, built from layers that suit its style and shaped by three descriptive words from the list. It is mixed with EQ and plug-ins and may use Apple Loops as long as the arrangement is the student's own. They hand in a bounced .mp3 or .wav, the zipped .logicx project and a paragraph explaining how the song reflects their three words, plus a Padlet post with three feedback questions, then play the piece and present it.

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Teaches functional composition — making music for a purpose beyond personal expression. Students learn to work from a creative brief.

STANDARDS ·

Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music (Music Technology, high school): generating and developing ideas (MU:Cr1.1, MU:Cr2.1), presenting work (MU:Pr6.1) and responding to it (MU:Re7.2).

GOALS ·

- Compose music driven by descriptive keywords rather than personal preference
- Understand what makes music functional for media use
- Practice efficient composition within a defined length and mood
- Develop skills in matching musical choices to a visual or emotional context

AT A GLANCE ·

Grades	9–12: the second-year course, after a first year of Logic Pro basics
Length	7 class periods: choose words and plan, three working days, mix and reflect, bounce, present
Software	Logic Pro: instruments, Apple Loops, arrangement, automation, EQ and plug-ins, bounce
You supply	Macs with Logic Pro, headphones, a feedback board and a place to submit files
Assessment	My rubric, 5 categories scored 1–5, /25; final grade = average of the student's and the teacher's score (page 21)

BEFORE THEY START

Students should already know how to open a project, add software instruments and loops, use the Mixer, and save, bounce and zip in Logic. Nobody needs to read music.

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ROYALTY FREE

Setup and what to watch

SETUP

Teacher

YOU NEED ·

- **A Mac with Logic Pro** for each student, and **headphones**. Speakers help for the final listen.
- **A place to submit** the .mp3 or .wav, the zipped .logicx and the reflection paragraph (your class page).
- **The Presentation Padlet**, set up before Class 1 (yours to set up; none is included).
- **The Word list**, printed (page 13), or your own copy of the list on your class page.
- **A rule for Apple Loops** (requirement 3): loops are allowed but the arrangement must be original. Decide what that means (for example, no loop used untouched for the whole piece) and write it on the board.
- **Printed student pages**, one set each (pages 13–24).

BEFORE CLASS 1 ·

- [ ] Set up the Presentation Padlet in your class page.
- [ ] Decide your Apple Loops rule and how you will check it (page 17).
- [ ] Choose the video you might use for the Harder variation, if any (page 10).
- [ ] Check that a student computer opens Logic and plays back through headphones.

WHAT TO WATCH (MY STRUGGLES) ·

Students ignore their three words, tracks feel incomplete at one minute, students lean on Apple Loops, and the reflection paragraph is an afterthought. Pairs well with real district videos. Students love knowing their music might actually get used.

KIT SUGGESTIONS, NOT PART OF MY SHEETS

- Ways to use the word list: students pick their own three, or you spin a wheel and let them swap one.
- Real uses to name on Class 1: a sports highlight, a facilities tour, an announcement, a club promo. Ask what each one needs.
- Ask while students work: which of your words is this layer for? Where does the peak happen?

SOUNDS THEY DID NOT MAKE ·

A KIT SUGGESTION

Remind students that “royalty-free” means no copyrighted samples: they use their own sounds, instruments and Apple Loops from Logic, and they hand in only their own track.

KEEP THE VOLUME MODERATE

Bright sounds and loud peaks are tiring in headphones. Tell students to start low and to check the final mix at a normal level.

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ROYALTY FREE

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction and word list. Choose 3 words, brainstorm, begin composing.	Slides 1–7: hook, what the project is, the five steps, four words to know, steps 1 and 2. Hand out the project sheet, the Word list and the Creative brief. Check that each student has 3 words before they leave.	Slides 1–7	p. 13, p. 14, p. 18, p. 19, p. 20, p. 22
CLASS 2	**Classes 2–4:** Working days — compose and refine your 1-minute piece.	Slides 8–9: words become sound, and your 3 words are your brief. Hand out the Listening log. Then work time.	Slides 8–9	p. 15
CLASS 3		Slides 10–12: step 3, build-peak-resolve and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Arrangement plan and the Layers and mix sheet. Then work time.	Slides 10–12	p. 16, p. 17
CLASS 4		Slide 13: one minute goes fast. Then work time. Ask each student to play their first 20 seconds and say which word they hear.	Slide 13	—
CLASS 5	**Class 5:** Mix and finalize. Write reflection paragraph.	Slides 14–15: step 4, mix, and steps 5 and 6, the reflection paragraph and the bounce. Students plan their paragraph on the Reflection page (page 24).	Slides 14–15	p. 24
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 16–17: what to turn in and the rubric. Students bounce, name their files and post their three Padlet questions.	Slides 16–17	p. 21, p. 23
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions.	Slides 18–19	p. 23

THE ONE THING TO DO ON CLASS 1

Ask each student to name where their music could be used (my first tip) and to write three words on the Creative brief before they leave. If a word is only what they like, ask: how would you play that word to someone who had never heard it?

CLASSES 2–4

Working days; Class 4 has one slide. Circulate with one question: which of your three words is this layer for?

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WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Teaches functional composition — making music for a purpose beyond personal expression. Students learn to work from a creative brief.

COMMON STUDENT STRUGGLES ·

- Students ignore their 3 words and just make what they want.
- Tracks feel incomplete at 1 minute. Encourage a simple arc: build, peak, resolve.
- Over-reliance on Apple Loops with minimal original arrangement.
- Reflection paragraph is an afterthought.

SUGGESTED VARIATIONS ·

Easier: Reduce to 2 descriptive words and provide a structural template.

More Advanced: Require students to score their track to an actual video clip.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH EACH STRUGGLE

- Ignoring the words: the Creative brief (page 14), slide 8 and the word check on the Layers and mix sheet (page 17).
- Incomplete at 1 minute: slide 11 and the Arrangement plan (page 16) show a build, a peak and a resolve.
- Too many Apple Loops: the layer log on the Layers and mix sheet (page 17) and the worked example (page 12).
- An afterthought paragraph: the Reflection planner (page 24), with a thin and a useful example.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH THE VARIATIONS (KIT SUGGESTION)

- Easier: a blank structural template and a 2-word brief (page 10).
- More advanced: a hit-point sheet for scoring to a clip you choose (page 10).

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SUGGESTED RESOURCES ·

MY LIST	IN THIS KIT
Descriptive word list (on your class page)	Kept as your own list, which is yours to post. The kit prints the same words as a student page, the Word list (page 13), so students can circle theirs on paper.
Royalty-Free Music Sources doc	Kept as I wrote it, but it is not included: it names real tracks, artists and links. The Listening log (page 15) uses its six "What to Dissect" lenses with no track named, so students study a piece they choose.
Examples of royalty-free music in real corporate/school videos	Kept as I wrote it. Nothing is included: the examples are yours to choose and play. The Listening log (page 15) is where students write what they hear in them.

HOW TO GRADE ·

- My rubric: five categories, each scored 1–5, /25 (page 21). Students score themselves first; the final grade is the average of their score and yours.

Suggestions from this kit, not part of my rubric:

- Creativity & Originality: ask how the three words shaped the choices, then listen for what is the student's own. Apple Loops are allowed; a loop left untouched is the default in the 1 column.
- Technical Skill: open the project. Which layers are the student's own and which are loops (Layers and mix, page 17)? Are EQ and plug-ins really in use?
- Composition & Structure: compare the piece with the Arrangement plan (page 16). Is there a build, a peak and a resolve (my second struggle), or one long loop?
- Sound Design & Mix Quality: close your eyes and listen for each of the three words. Is every layer audible, and does the mix still carry the words?
- Documentation & Presentation: the Creative brief (page 14), the reflection paragraph (page 24) and the Padlet questions are the evidence.

NOTES / OBSERVATIONS ·

Pairs well with real district videos. Students love knowing their music might actually get used.

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ROYALTY FREE

What changed from the original

CHANGES

Teacher

This kit is built from three of my documents: the **Project Sheet & Rubric**, the **Teacher Notes** and the **Royalty Free** entry on my DMP2 project menu. This page lists every change to my wording, so you know exactly what is mine and what was added.

WORDING CHANGES ·

- My LMS name is written as “your class page” (the word list resource and checklist items 1, 2 and 4).
- Page numbers are added to steps 1 to 5 (the Word list, Creative brief, Listening log, Arrangement plan, Layers and mix sheet and Reflection page).
- Tip 4 is written “on YouTube or a free music library” where I named a website, because that site is a third-party name. No site, track, artist or link is included anywhere in the kit.
- The Word list (page 13) is my “Groups of Words” sheet from the older Royalty Free folder, printed A to Z with a circle by each of its 160 words. No word is added or removed, and spellings are kept (both Mesmerizing and Mesmerising).
- My Royalty-Free Music Sources doc is not included, because it names real tracks, artists and links. The Listening log (page 15) uses its six “What to Dissect” lenses. My third resource, examples of royalty-free music in real videos, is yours to choose.
- My Easier variation (2 words and a structural template) is laid out on page 10 with a structural template that is the kit’s own (intro, build, peak, resolve). My Harder variation (score to an actual video clip) is laid out as a hit-point sheet on the same page; no video is included.
- My pacing guide’s “Classes 2–4” row spans the Class 2, 3 and 4 rows, so each class can name its slides.
- Layout only: the rubric’s Name and Date lines moved to the top; its Notes box became ruled lines.
- **Reflection page, not a new task (page 24).** My sheet already asks for a reflection paragraph (requirement 6, step 5, checklist), so this kit adds no extra task. It adds a planner only, because my fourth struggle says the paragraph is an afterthought, plus two looking-back prompts that follow my definition (a written or oral conversation about how the student did and what they would do differently), so you may take those orally. No points, no rubric row.
- The intro deck shortens my wording (full wording on pages 18–20): slide 3 shortens my overview and goals, slide 6 shortens my four vocabulary definitions, slide 7 shortens steps 1 and 2, slide 9 shortens tip 3 and my first struggle, slide 10 shortens step 3 and requirements 3 and 4, slide 13 shortens tip 2 and my second struggle, slide 14 shortens step 4 and requirement 5, slide 15 shortens steps 5 and 6, slide 16 shortens the submission checklist, and slide 18 shortens step 7.

KEPT AS I WROTE IT ·

Everything else from my three documents is kept as I wrote it: the overview, goals, four vocabulary terms, six requirements, steps (apart from the page numbers), tips (apart from tip 4), checklist (apart from the class page) and file name (“Your Name – Royalty Free – Word, Word, Word”), the /25 rubric, what the project reinforces, my four struggles, the variations, my three resources, my pacing, my closing note and the project menu entry on page 3. No rubric row is added and the requirements are unchanged.

NEW IN THIS KIT ·

Everything else is new and supports my sheets without changing them: the how-to, overview and setup pages, the teacher moves in the pacing guide, the grading suggestions, the Logic quick reference, the structural template and hit-point sheet, the worked example (an invented one-minute piece for an invented video, with its chords, sections, layers and lanes, on paper, not audio), the Creative brief, Listening log, Arrangement plan, Layers and mix sheet and Reflection planner, the vocabulary and presentation pages and the intro deck. None adds a requirement or a rubric row.

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ROYALTY FREE

Logic quick reference

SETUP

Teacher + student

Where to find the tools a Royalty Free project is likely to use. Demonstrate what your class needs on Classes 1 and 2 and then let students work. Names are from current Logic Pro versions; labels move between versions, so check yours.

New project and tracks	File › New…, then add tracks with Track › New Tracks…: Software Instrument tracks for pads, keys, bass and bells, and Drummer or Apple Loops for drums.
Apple Loops	Open the Loop Browser (O) and drag a loop into a track. Apple Loops are allowed here, but the arrangement must be your own: cut loops, repeat them, drop layers in and out, and add your own parts (my third struggle).
Tempo and length	Set the tempo in the control bar. Bars × 240 ÷ tempo = seconds; at 120 BPM, 30 bars is 60 seconds. The Arrangement plan has a length helper.
Sections	Show Global Tracks (G) and add arrangement markers named Intro, Build, Peak and Resolve, so the form is visible in the project.
Layers	Add one layer at a time. Mute and unmute tracks, or cut regions, to bring layers in and out of the sections.
Automation	Press A to show track automation. Pick a parameter, such as filter cutoff, volume, pan or reverb send, and draw points so the sound moves.
EQ, pan, plug-ins	Add Channel EQ for balance, use each track's Pan knob, and add plug-ins such as a reverb or filter. Press X for the Mixer.
Endings	A resolve usually means layers leave and the last chord settles. Use volume automation or a fade, and check that nothing is cut off at the end.
Scoring to video (Harder)	Choose Open Movie from the File menu or the Window menu in your version, and open a clip you have the right to use. Add markers at the moments the music should hit (see the Easier and Harder variations page).
Bounce and zip	File › Bounce › Project or Section (Command-B), MP3 or WAV. In Finder, Control-click the .logicx and choose Compress.

VERSION NOTE

Menu names are from current Logic Pro versions; older versions may differ slightly. Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe what the project needs. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

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ROYALTY FREE

Easier and Harder variations

TEACHER

Easier + Harder

My Easier variation: reduce to 2 descriptive words and provide a structural template. The words are your choice, and the template below is the kit's own (it is not one of my sheets). Copy it onto the board or hand it out.

EASIER: A STRUCTURAL TEMPLATE FOR ONE MINUTE ·

SECTION	BARS
Intro	bars 1–4 · 4 bars
Build	bars 5–12 · 8 bars
Peak	bars 13–22 · 10 bars
Resolve	bars 23–30 · 8 bars

30 bars at 120 BPM = 60 seconds. At another tempo, use the length helper on page 16.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Two words instead of three; the brief on page 14 has room for a third.
2. Fill the sections: the intro has the fewest layers, the peak the most, the resolve thins out.
3. Students may change the bar counts as long as the piece is about a minute.

HARDER: SCORE YOUR TRACK TO A REAL VIDEO CLIP ·

My More Advanced variation. No video is included: choose a clip you have the right to use (a district video, or one your students shot). Students watch it first, write down where something happens on screen, and decide what the music does at that moment.

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS ON SCREEN	WHAT THE MUSIC DOES	WHICH WORD

CHECK

- ☐ The first section starts where the video starts, and the resolve ends with it.
- ☐ The peak lands on the most important moment of the clip.
- ☐ The music does not cover any speech in the clip.

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ROYALTY FREE

Worked example · an invented piece

EXAMPLE

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Open Doors", described on paper**, for a one-minute tour of a renovated school library (an invented video): no audio is included. Students' projects will differ. 30 bars at 120 BPM, three words, four sections, seven layers (page 1 of 2).

1 · A WEAK PLAN

I will make a happy song with a nice beat.

It names no words and nothing says why any choice was made.

2 · A CLEAR PLAN

My video is a one-minute tour of a renovated school library (an invented video). My three words are Bright, Steady and Uplifting. Bright: bells and plucked keys in a major key, with the highs lifted a little. Steady: 120 BPM that never changes, a kick on every beat and one chord for every two bars. Uplifting: a bell melody that climbs, a new layer every few bars, and an ending that lands on the home chord. It is 30 bars, 60 seconds, in four sections: intro, build, peak and resolve. Two layers are Apple Loops that I cut and rearrange.

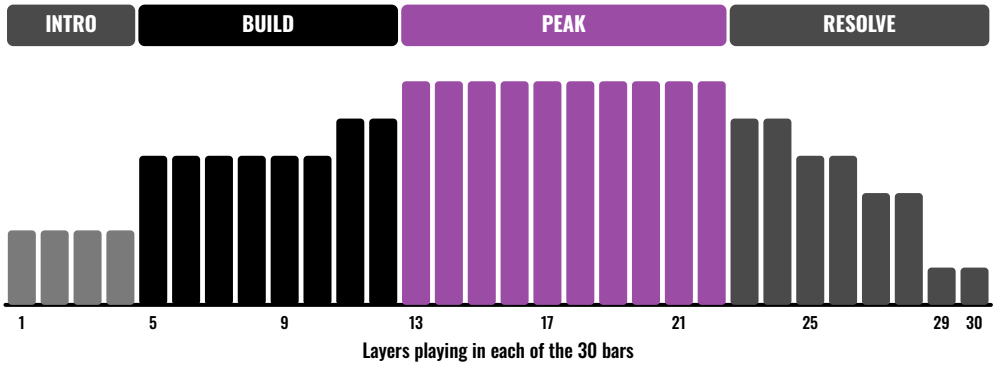
3 · THREE WORDS, FOUR KINDS OF CHOICE ·

	BRIGHT	STEADY	UPLIFTING
SOUNDS	bells · plucked keys	soft pad · bass	bell melody climbs
RHYTHM	light, clear hits	kick on every beat	drums enter in the Build
HARMONY	major key (C)	one chord per 2 bars	ends on home chord C
MIX	highs lifted	nothing jumps out	opens up in the Peak

Every choice connects back to a word

WORD	SOUNDS	RHYTHM	HARMONY	MIX
Bright	bells · plucked keys	light, clear hits	major key (C)	highs lifted
Steady	soft pad · bass	kick on every beat	one chord per 2 bars	nothing jumps out
Uplifting	bell melody climbs	drums enter in the Build	ends on home chord C	opens up in the Peak

4 · BUILD, PEAK, RESOLVE: LAYERS IN EACH BAR ·



Layers playing in each of the 30 bars

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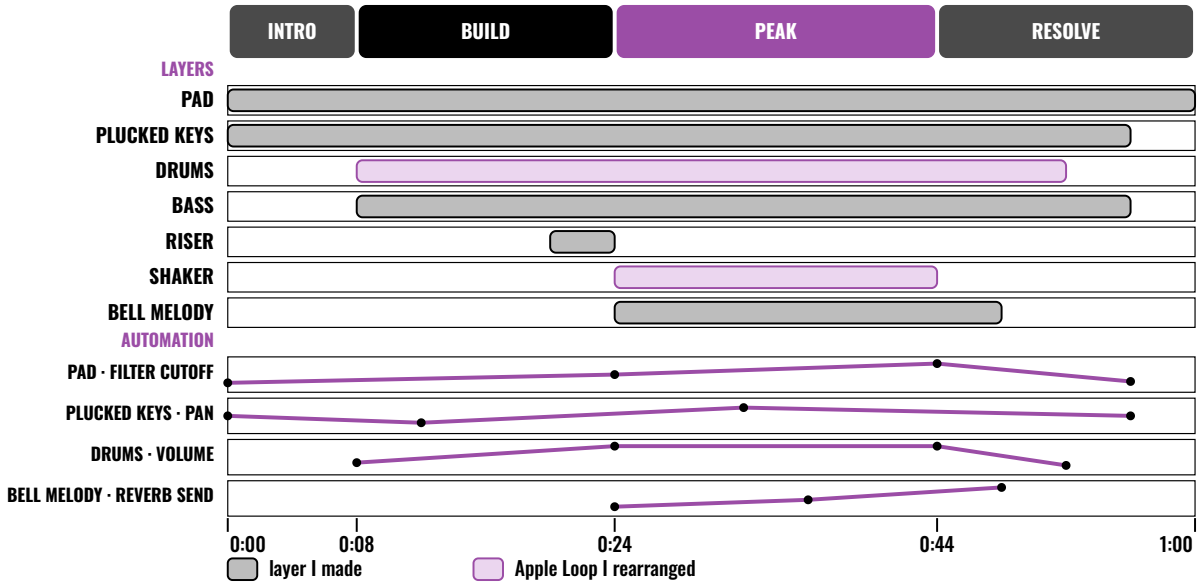
Worked example · the map

EXAMPLE

Teacher

"Open Doors", page 2 of 2: the map of the whole piece, then the numbers.

5 · THE MAP: 1:00, FOUR SECTIONS, SEVEN LAYERS, FOUR LANES ·



6 · SECTIONS

Intro	bars 1–4	pad and plucked keys alone; C then G, two bars each
Build	bars 5–12	bass and drums enter at bar 5; a riser sweeps up in bars 11–12
Peak	bars 13–22	shaker and bell melody join at bar 13; the drums and pad are at their loudest
Resolve	bars 23–30	layers leave one by one; the last four bars are C, with the pad alone at the end

7 · LAYERS (IN TO OUT)

Pad	a soft synth pad I play and shape myself	0:00–1:00
Plucked keys	a plucked keyboard I play, one chord per two bars	0:00–0:56
Drums	an Apple Loop drum groove; I cut it, drop the hi-hat in the Build and write my own fill at bar 12	0:08–0:52
Bass	root notes I write on a bass instrument	0:08–0:56
Riser	a filter sweep I automate on a synth, bars 11–12	0:20–0:24
Shaker	an Apple Loop shaker, chopped so it only plays in the Peak	0:24–0:44
Bell melody	a bell melody I write, four notes a bar, all chord tones	0:24–0:48

8 · THE CHORDS, BAR BY BAR (THE BASS PLAYS EACH ROOT: C2, G1, A1, F1; THE BELL MELODY USES ONLY CHORD TONES)

C 1–2	G 3–4	Am 5–6	F 7–8	C 9–10	G 11–12	C 13–14	G 15–16	Am 17–18	F 19–20	G 21–22	F 23–24	G 25–26	C 27–30

9 · AUTOMATION LANES

Pad · filter cutoff	0:00–0:56
Plucked keys · pan	0:00–0:56
Drums · volume	0:08–0:52
Bell melody · reverb send	0:24–0:48

10 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

One bar of 4/4 at 120 BPM lasts 240 ÷ 120 = 2 seconds, so 30 bars = 60 seconds, my "1 minute". The sections are 4 + 8 + 10 + 8 bars = 30. Two of seven layers are Apple Loops, and both are cut and rearranged. **Three Padlet questions (invented):** 1. Which of the three words did you hear first? 2. Where did the music feel like it was building, and where did it peak? 3. What would you change so it fits the video even better?

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ROYALTY FREE

Word list

STUDENT

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Step 1: review the word list and pick 3 that define your track's mood. Requirement 2: choose 3 descriptive words from the provided list. Descriptive words are adjectives that define the mood and character of a piece (e.g., "upbeat," "cinematic"). Circle three, then copy them onto your Creative brief. The words are listed A to Z.

- ○ Acoustic
- ○ Adventure
- ○ Alternative
- ○ Ambient
- ○ Ballad
- ○ Baroque
- ○ Beautiful
- ○ Biphonic
- ○ Bittersweet
- ○ Bluegrass
- ○ Blues
- ○ Bluesy
- ○ Breathtaking
- ○ Breathy
- ○ Bright
- ○ Calming
- ○ Catchy
- ○ Ceremonial
- ○ Choral
- ○ Classic
- ○ Classical
- ○ Complex
- ○ Computerised
- ○ Contemporary
- ○ Country
- ○ Cultural
- ○ Dainty
- ○ Depressing
- ○ Diminishing
- ○ Distinct
- ○ Drab
- ○ Dramatic
- ○ Dynamic
- ○ Eclectic
- ○ Electric
- ○ Electronic
- ○ Emotional
- ○ Empowering
- ○ Enchanting
- ○ Energetic
- ○ Enigmatic
- ○ Enthusiastic
- ○ Epic
- ○ Ethereal
- ○ Exciting
- ○ Exhilarating
- ○ Expressive
- ○ Extravagant
- ○ Faint
- ○ Feel-good
- ○ Flat
- ○ Fluid
- ○ Folk
- ○ Fortissimo
- ○ Frantic
- ○ Fresh
- ○ Funky
- ○ Gentle
- ○ Glorious
- ○ Gradual
- ○ Grandiose
- ○ Groovy
- ○ Groundbreaking
- ○ Happy
- ○ Hardcore
- ○ Harmonic
- ○ Harmonious
- ○ Harmonised
- ○ Haunting
- ○ Healing
- ○ Heartfelt
- ○ Heterophonic
- ○ Hip-Hop
- ○ Hypnotic
- ○ Inciting
- ○ Indie
- ○ Indulgent
- ○ Inspirational
- ○ Inspiring
- ○ Instrumental
- ○ Intense
- ○ Invigorating
- ○ Jazz
- ○ Jazzy
- ○ Joyful
- ○ Latin
- ○ Life-changing
- ○ Light
- ○ Loud
- ○ Lyrical
- ○ Magical
- ○ Majestic
- ○ Melancholic
- ○ Melancholy
- ○ Mellow
- ○ Melodic
- ○ Melodious
- ○ Mesmerising
- ○ Mesmerizing
- ○ Monophonic
- ○ Moody
- ○ Motivating
- ○ Motivational
- ○ Musical
- ○ Mythical
- ○ Natural
- ○ New Age
- ○ Nostalgic
- ○ Opera
- ○ Orchestral
- ○ Passionate
- ○ Poetic
- ○ Poignant
- ○ Polyphonic
- ○ Pop
- ○ Powerful
- ○ Progressive Rock
- ○ Radical
- ○ Rap
- ○ Refined
- ○ Rejuvenating
- ○ Relaxing
- ○ Restoring
- ○ Rhythmic
- ○ Rich
- ○ Riveting
- ○ Romantic
- ○ Sad
- ○ Saturated
- ○ Sentimental
- ○ Shrill
- ○ Simple
- ○ Slow
- ○ Smooth
- ○ Soaring
- ○ Soft
- ○ Sombre
- ○ Sonic
- ○ Soothing
- ○ Sophisticated
- ○ Soulful
- ○ Staccato
- ○ Steady
- ○ Stratospheric
- ○ Stylized
- ○ Sublime
- ○ Symphonic
- ○ Synthetic
- ○ Talented
- ○ Tempo
- ○ Thrilling
- ○ Tranquil
- ○ Transcendent
- ○ Upbeat
- ○ Uplifting
- ○ Vibrant
- ○ Visionary
- ○ Vocal
- ○ Warm
- ○ Wonderous

MY THREE WORDS

Word 1: _____ **Word 2:** _____ **Word 3:** _____

Why they go together: _____

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ROYALTY FREE

Creative brief

STUDENT

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

Step 2: brainstorm how instruments, rhythm, and melody bring those words to life. Your 3 words are your creative brief. Every choice should connect back to them. Think about where this music would actually be used.

THE BRIEF

Where my music would be used (the kind of video): _____

What the person watching should feel: _____

MY WORD	SOUNDS AND INSTRUMENTS	RHYTHM AND TEMPO	MELODY AND HARMONY	HOW THE MIX FEELS

CHECK THE BRIEF

- ☐ Every word has at least one sound, one rhythm choice and one harmony choice behind it.
- ☐ I can say which word each layer is for.
- ☐ My words fit the video, not only what I like.

My tempo: _____ **My key or mood:** _____

If a stranger heard my track with no title, the three words they would pick: _____

The word I think will be hardest to hear, and my plan for it: _____

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ROYALTY FREE

Listening log

STUDENT

Classes 2–3

Name _____ Date _____

Step 2: plan. Listen to royalty-free music and study how it is built. Choose a piece yourself, from YouTube or a free music library (no music is included in this kit). Take ideas about how it works, not its notes: your arrangement must be your own.

THE PIECE

Title and where I found it: _____

Three descriptive words I would give it: _____

WHAT TO DISSECT	WHAT I HEAR	AN IDEA I CAN USE
Song structure How are the sections laid out? Where does it build or change?		
Instrumentation Which instruments or sounds are used, and what does each add to the feel?		
Loops and repetition What repeats? How does the producer keep it interesting?		
Emotional impact What mood does it give, and which instrument or choice creates it?		
Transitions How does it get from one section to the next? Smooth or abrupt?		
Application to visuals Where could it be used (sports, tours, announcements)? What would not fit?		

Something I will not do, because it does not fit my words: _____

One thing in this piece I will try in my own way: _____

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ROYALTY FREE

Arrangement plan

STUDENT

Classes 2–4

Name _____ Date _____

Step 3: build your 1-minute piece in Logic. Tracks feel incomplete at 1 minute, so give it a simple arc: build, peak, resolve. Shade the bars where each layer plays and write the layer's name at the left. Mark where each section starts. Use layers appropriate to the style.

Layer	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36

MY SECTIONS (INTRO · BUILD · PEAK · RESOLVE)

Intro: _____ **bars** _____

Build: _____ **bars** _____

Peak: _____ **bars** _____

Resolve: _____ **bars** _____

LENGTH HELPER (1 MINUTE)

BPM	BARS FOR 60 S	ONE BAR
80	20	3.00 s
96	24	2.50 s
100	25	2.40 s
120	30	2.00 s
128	32	1.88 s
144	36	1.67 s

My tempo: _____ **Bars:** _____ **Length: bars × 240 ÷ tempo =** _____ **seconds**

The peak is in bars _____ **because** _____

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Layers and mix sheet

STUDENT

Classes 3–5

Name _____ Date _____

Step 4: EQ, pan, and balance your tracks. Requirement 5: apply EQ and plug-ins to shape your mix. Apple Loops are allowed, but the arrangement must be your own: say below what you made and what you changed.

LAYER	SOURCE (MY OWN · APPLE LOOP · BOTH)	WHAT I WROTE OR CHANGED MYSELF	EQ · PAN · PLUG-IN

WORD CHECK: CLOSE YOUR EYES AND LISTEN

MY WORD	WHERE I HEAR IT (BAR OR TIME)	IF I DO NOT HEAR IT, WHAT I WILL FIX

CHECKS BEFORE I BOUNCE

- ☐ There are no copyrighted samples. Every sound is mine or from Logic.
- ☐ No Apple Loop plays untouched for the whole piece; I cut, repeat or rebuild each one.
- ☐ I can hear every layer, and none is buried or too loud.
- ☐ EQ and at least one plug-in are in use.
- ☐ The piece is about 1 minute (give or take a few seconds).

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Name _____ Date _____

ROYALTY FREE

Digital Music Production | *Structured Project* | 7 class periods

OVERVIEW ·

You're composing music for the real world. Create a 1-minute piece of royalty-free music that could score a video for the school district — anything from sports highlights to facilities tours. Your sound and mood will be guided by 3 descriptive words you choose from a provided list.

GOALS ·

- Compose music driven by descriptive keywords rather than personal preference
- Understand what makes music functional for media use
- Practice efficient composition within a defined length and mood
- Develop skills in matching musical choices to a visual or emotional context

KEY VOCABULARY ·

Royalty-Free	Music that can be used without paying ongoing fees — no copyrighted samples
Descriptive Words	Adjectives that define the mood and character of a piece (e.g., "upbeat," "cinematic")
Scoring	Writing music specifically designed to accompany visual media
Apple Loops	Pre-made loops in Logic — allowed here, but arrangement must be your own

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ROYALTY FREE

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- [ ] Length: 1 minute (give or take a few seconds)
- [ ] Choose 3 descriptive words from the provided list
- [ ] Your music must be royalty-free — no copyrighted samples. Apple Loops allowed but arrangement must be original.
- [ ] Use layers appropriate to the style
- [ ] Apply EQ and plug-ins to shape your mix
- [ ] Write a short paragraph explaining how your song reflects your 3 chosen words

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Choose your words** — Review the word list and pick 3 that define your track's mood (Word list: page 13)
2. **Plan** — Brainstorm how instruments, rhythm, and melody bring those words to life (Creative brief: page 14; Listening log: page 15)
3. **Compose** — Build your 1-minute piece in Logic (Arrangement plan: page 16)
4. **Mix** — EQ, pan, and balance your tracks (Layers and mix sheet: page 17)
5. Write your reflection paragraph explaining your creative choices (Reflection page: page 24)
6. **Finalize** — Bounce your track with the correct file name format
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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ROYALTY FREE

Project sheet · tips and checklist

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

TIPS FOR SUCCESS ·

- Think about where this music would actually be used. Keep that context in mind.
- 1 minute goes fast. Don't cram too many ideas in — pick a vibe and commit.
- Your 3 words are your creative brief. Every choice should connect back to them.
- Listen to royalty-free music on YouTube or a free music library for inspiration.

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST ·

- ☐ Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Zipped .logicx project file uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Files named correctly: "Your Name – Royalty Free – Word, Word, Word"
- ☐ Reflection paragraph submitted via your class page
- ☐ Padlet post created with your 3 feedback questions
- ☐ Answered at least 2 questions on classmates' Padlet posts during presentations

NOTES ·

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ROYALTY FREE

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Royalty Free | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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ROYALTY FREE

Key vocabulary

STUDENT

Vocabulary

Name _____ Date _____

The four words from your project sheet, with my definitions. Rewrite each in your own words, then show where it happens in your own project.

ROYALTY-FREE — Music that can be used without paying ongoing fees — no copyrighted samples

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

DESCRIPTIVE WORDS — Adjectives that define the mood and character of a piece (e.g., “upbeat,” “cinematic”)

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

SCORING — Writing music specifically designed to accompany visual media

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

APPLE LOOPS — Pre-made loops in Logic — allowed here, but arrangement must be your own

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my track: _____

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ROYALTY FREE

Present and get feedback

STUDENT

Classes 6–7

Name _____ Date _____

FROM YOUR PROJECT SHEET, STEP 7

Present & Get Feedback — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

MY THREE FEEDBACK QUESTIONS ·

Ask about things you really want to know, not yes-or-no questions.

Question 1: _____

Question 2: _____

Question 3: _____

CLASSMATES' QUESTIONS I ANSWERED (AT LEAST 2) ·

CLASSMATE	THEIR QUESTION	MY ANSWER

BEFORE I PRESENT ·

- ☐ Files named "Your Name – Royalty Free – Word, Word, Word"; the .mp3 or .wav and zipped .logicx submitted
- ☐ Reflection paragraph submitted (page 24)
- ☐ Padlet post created with my 3 questions
- ☐ Rubric self-score done (page 21)

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ROYALTY FREE

STUDENT

Reflection · how does it reflect my words?

Class 5

Name _____ Date _____

WHAT THIS PAGE IS

My sheet asks for a short paragraph explaining how your song reflects your 3 chosen words. Fill in prompts 1 to 3, then write your paragraph on your class page. Prompts 4 and 5 follow my definition: a reflection is a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time; you may talk them through with your teacher instead.

THIN (AN INVENTED EXAMPLE)

My song is bright and steady and uplifting. I used bells and drums and it is happy. I think it sounds good and fits my words. I liked making it.

USEFUL (AN INVENTED EXAMPLE)

Bright is the bell melody and the plucked keys in C major, with the highs lifted in the mix. Steady is the 120 BPM pulse with the kick on every beat; I did not change tempo once. Uplifting is the climb: a new layer arrives about every four bars, the bell melody rises to its highest note in the Peak, and the last chord settles on C. Next time I would try a quieter intro.

1 **Word 1:** Name it, say what you did to show it, and where we can hear it.

2 **Word 2:** Name it, say what you did to show it, and where we can hear it.

3 **Word 3:** Name it, say what you did to show it, and where we can hear it.

4 **What would you do differently next time?** Be specific: a step, a choice, a sound or a tool.

5 **Look at the rubric (page 21).** Which category are you proudest of, and which would you work on first next time?

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QUESTIONS?

Please use the Q&A tab on the Hudson Beat by Brian Lotze store on Teachers Pay Teachers. If something looks wrong, let me know there and I will fix it.

CREDITS

- Project sheet, rubric, teacher notes and intro deck: original work by Brian Lotze, Hudson Beat.
- Worked example (an invented one-minute piece for an invented video, with its chords, sections, layers and automation lanes, described on paper), the hero, card, brief, arc and arrangement drawings and layouts: original work, Hudson Beat.
- The Word list is the owner's "Groups of Words" sheet. No audio, video, lyrics, album art, screenshots, presets, templates, links or chart data are included. No student work is included. Padlet is named only as the owner's own materials name it.
- Text fonts: Oswald (The Oswald Project Authors) and Source Sans 3 (Adobe), SIL Open Font License 1.1.
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Designed with the help of digital and AI tools, and checked by hand.